

ALL THE QUEEN'S HORSES

Elizabeth adored horses from the age of four, when she first sat on Peggy the pony. She loved seeing her racehorses run, especially Aureole in the 1950s, Highclere in the 1970s, and Estimate, winner of the Ascot Gold Cup in 2013. She loved show-jumping too, proudly watching Princess Anne ride her horse Doublet to become European eventing champion of 1971. The Queen was particularly fond of riding her own Betsy, bought from a farmer, and Sanction, who seemed to understand her perfectly.



By 1977, Elizabeth had been queen for 25 years, but no one was sure how much enthusiasm her Silver Jubilee would generate. As ever, the government wanted to keep costs down, and so did she.

On tour, the Queen had a warm welcome in Australia, New Zealand, and the Pacific. When she came home, the celebrations in the UK took the government by surprise. Towns and villages organized street parties. A vast number of people (said to be a million) packed a road called the Mall in London to cheer the Queen as she drove to a church service